Monday Nite Footballers Predictions

By Jim Nunnelly

Pittsburgh Steelers
Vs.
Kansas City Chiefs

Saturday, Dec. 18, At 11:30 A.M.

Arrowhead Stadium

KCTV-5 And KCFX 101 The Fox

Chatter, Conversation And Commentary

Charles Allen, Carl Clark, Lloyd Greenfield, Ed West, and I told you that the Chiefs would beat the Minnesota Vikings last Sunday night at Arrowhead. It wasn't pretty and as usual, the Chiefs scared us, especially after Minnesota came back after being held 21-0. Just as we predicted, there were lots of mistakes with special unmentionables going to the special teams. Like we said, the Chiefs had never put together a total victory and Sunday night was no exception. The special teams allowed two touchdowns to be run back on them, one by the fast-of-foot receiver, Randy Moss. The defense played well, with special kudos for the resurrected Derrick Thomas. The offense played okay, and Grbac did not hurt us too much. In fact it could be said Grbac was respectable, especially in the two-minute drive in the final seconds that led to Stoyanovich's last second, game winning field goal. Now that we've won and are now in a two-way tie for first place with Seattle, what must we do to win Saturday against failing Pittsburgh?

Right away, Ike Gardner says we must put first teamers on the special teams. If you notice, other teams treat the special teams as an essential component of the team. The Chiefs seem to crowd the special team with rookies and also rans, giving this vital unit second class and unimportant status. In addition, the Chiefs have to jump on Pittsburgh's quarterback quickly and harshly, just as they did Minnesota's brittle quarterback Jeff George. Had it not been for getting the jump on George, the outcome of the game would have been radically different. Then, we must continue to mix up our offense. Passing on first and second down was refreshing and finding Gonzalez more often is critical. If the Chiefs do this, then they can be ready for the "showdown in Seattle" the day after Christmas. But let's not go too far too fast and get back to Saturday morning with the Steelers.

The Steelers are struggling badly. They've replaced "Slash" Kordell Stewart and put him back at wide receiver. The Iron Curtain defense is now aluminum and they've got real problems with special teams. Even Ike Gardner thinks the Chiefs will win this Saturday, along with the regular Chiefs's supporters. Only Paul Booker remains stubborn, in spite of the Chiefs three straight victories. He thinks "Slash" will be instrumental. However, Ed West thinks the "Slash" will get slashed, and allow the Chiefs to tighten their hold on first place. In case Denver should beat Seattle, then the Chiefs would possess first place all alone. That would be great because if the Chiefs win all of their remaining games, then they would win the division outright. All things considered, the Chiefs will be 9-5 on Sunday morning.

Here's what we think:

PREDICTIONS

MEMBERS	PREDICTION	COMMENT
Charles Allen	Chiefs by 14	Playing a poor team.
Paul Booker	Steelers by 7	The "Slash" slashes.
Carl Clark	Chiefs by 10	Nothing going for 'em.
Ike Gardner	Chiefs by 3	Santa is on his way.
Ollie Hubbard	Chiefs by 7	It's a miracle coming.
Jim Nunnelly	Chiefs by 3	Hasty, Cloud, two Derricks.
Ed West	Chiefs by 7	"Slash" has been slashed.

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